



Tarikh

Never miss a tarikh.

Product Requirements Document

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An AI-powered WhatsApp assistant for solo Indian lawyers.
Tracks every case date. Answers questions about your schedule.
Understands Hinglish, typos, and the way lawyers actually speak.

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01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What is Tarikh?

Tarikh is an AI-powered WhatsApp assistant built specifically for solo Indian lawyers. It helps them track every court case, never miss a hearing, and manage their entire legal practice through simple WhatsApp messages — in any language, any format, with no new app to download.

India has over 1.7 million registered advocates. The overwhelming majority practice alone — no clerks, no software, no support system. They manage 5 to 15 active cases using a physical diary and their own memory. When a hearing date is missed, careers and client relationships are damaged permanently.

Tarikh solves this with a single WhatsApp number. After every hearing, a lawyer sends one message — case name, date, court. Tarikh understands it, confirms it back, and handles everything from there: reminders, schedule queries, conflict detection, case notes, and weekly summaries.

1.7M+**Registered advocates in India**

The largest legal workforce globally with minimal digital infrastructure

87%**Cases in district courts**

Where lawyers have the least support and the most cases

0**Proactive reminders from the court system**

The cause list tells you today. Nothing tells you next week.

"I built Tarikh after watching a lawyer I know miss a hearing because he couldn't read his own diary entry. He's been practising for twelve years. It wasn't carelessness — it's just that nobody ever built anything for him."

— Founder, Tarikh

02 — THE PROBLEM

A diary and a prayer.

The Indian legal system processes over 50 million cases annually. The lawyers handling these cases — particularly at the district and subordinate court level — operate without any meaningful technological support.

The diary system is broken.

A physical diary with handwritten entries is the primary case management tool for most solo advocates. Dates get written in poor lighting, between hearings, in illegible handwriting. Adjournments happen verbally in court. If the lawyer doesn't update the diary in the next 10 minutes, the new date is at risk of being lost.

The court system gives no proactive support.

The eCourts portal lists hearing dates, but it requires the lawyer to check it manually. There are no automated reminders, no WhatsApp messages, no push notifications. The cause list tells you what's happening today — nothing tells you what's coming next week.

Existing apps are built for the wrong person.

Every legal case management app in India — Peshi, Lawyer Diary, CaseBench — requires structured data entry through a mobile interface. They work for a tech-comfortable, metro-based advocate. They fail completely for a district court lawyer who types in Hinglish, makes typos, and has no interest in learning new software.

The cost of missing a date is catastrophic.

Missing a court hearing is not a minor inconvenience. It can result in ex parte orders against a client, cost the lawyer their relationship with that client, and in serious cases lead to bar council complaints. The professional stakes are extremely high.

03 — PRODUCT VISION

The AI court clerk every lawyer deserves.

Tarikh's vision is to become the default operating layer for solo Indian advocates — the tool they use without thinking, the way they already use WhatsApp for everything else.

We are not building a reminder app. We are building a practice assistant that happens to live on WhatsApp. The reminder is the most visible output. The intelligence underneath — parsing unstructured language, maintaining case history, detecting conflicts, answering questions — is the actual product.

■ Works in the lawyer's language

Hindi, English, Hinglish, half-sentences, abbreviations, typos. Tarikh understands all of it without training the user to change their behaviour.

■ Lives where lawyers already are

WhatsApp has 500 million+ Indian users. Every lawyer already uses it daily. Zero onboarding friction. No new app. No new habit.

■ Knows the entire practice

Not just the next date — every case, every adjournment, every note, all accessible through conversation at any time.

■ Runs quietly in the background

Tarikh doesn't need attention until you need it. It sends the right message at the right time and stays out of the way otherwise.

04 — TARGET USER

The solo district court advocate.

Primary user — V1

Profile	Solo advocate, 28–50 years old, 5–20 years of practice
Location	District courts across India — tier 2 and tier 3 cities
Cases	5 to 15 active cases across Civil, Criminal, Family, Sessions courts
Support	No clerk. No junior. Manages everything personally.
Technology	Basic to mid-range Android smartphone. WhatsApp daily user.
Language	Communicates in Hinglish. Writes casually. Does not use formal app interfaces.
Income	■20,000 – ■80,000/month. Price sensitive. Needs clear value before paying.
Pain point	Tracking multiple case dates manually with no system and no reminders.

Secondary user — V2 and beyond

High court advocates managing larger case volumes. Small law firms with 2–5 advocates who want shared case tracking. Legal aid lawyers managing pro bono dockets.

05 — PRODUCT OVERVIEW

How Tarikh works.

Tarikh is a WhatsApp-native AI assistant. The lawyer interacts with it entirely through WhatsApp messages — adding cases, updating dates, asking questions, and receiving reminders. There is no app to download, no login, no dashboard to manage.

Adding a case

sharma vs state civil court next date 15 jan

Got it — Sharma vs State, Civil Court, 15th January. Reminder set for evening before and morning of.

Updating after a hearing

sharma matter adjourned to march 3rd evidence stage

Updated. Sharma vs State moved to 3rd March, evidence stage noted. Old date removed.

Asking your schedule

what do I have this week

4 hearings this week — Tue Civil Court 10AM, Wed Sessions 11:30AM, Thu Family Court 10AM & 2PM.

Conflict detection

patel matter district court 22 jan 11am

Heads up — you already have Singh vs State on 22nd Jan at 10:30AM. That's close. Save anyway?

Adding a case note

add note to sharma case — client needs 2019 documents

Note added to Sharma vs State. I'll include it in your 3rd March reminder.

06 — CORE FEATURES — V1

What the product does.

Case Tracking via WhatsApp

- Accept case details in any format — no structured input required
- Parse case name, court, date, and case type from natural language
- Confirm parsed details back to the lawyer immediately
- Store all case data persistently against the lawyer's WhatsApp number

Intelligent Language Understanding

- Full Hinglish support — Hindi-English mixed messages handled natively
- Typo tolerance — common misspellings corrected automatically
- Abbreviation recognition — HC, DC, SC, CrPC, IPC, etc.
- CNR number recognition and linking to eCourts data where available

Hearing Reminders

- Evening before reminder — sent at 7 PM the day before the hearing
- Morning of reminder — sent at 7 AM on the hearing day
- Custom reminder preferences — lawyer sets their own preferred time
- Reminder includes case name, court, court number, and any notes attached

Case Updates

- Update existing case dates after hearings — no duplicate entries
- Mark case stage — evidence, argument, order, execution
- Add notes to any case — included in the next reminder
- Archive or close cases when matters conclude

Schedule Intelligence

- On-demand schedule queries — "what do I have this week/Friday/in January"
- Monday morning weekly summary — full week's hearings sent automatically
- Conflict detection — flags when two hearings fall too close on the same day

- Case history — full timeline of every date and stage for any case

Multi-Court Support

- District Courts, High Courts, Sessions Courts, Family Courts, Tribunals
- Multiple courts in the same city handled simultaneously
- Court numbers and benches stored with each hearing

07 — HOW IT WORKS

Three steps. Zero friction.

01 After court, just message

The lawyer sends a WhatsApp message after the hearing. Case name, date, court. Any order. Any format. Hinglish is fine. Typos are fine. CNR number works too. No form to fill. No app to open. Just a message.

02 Tarikh confirms it back

Within seconds, Tarikh reads the message, parses the details, and sends a confirmation back. The lawyer can see exactly what was understood. If anything looks wrong, they correct it immediately — before walking out of the courthouse.

03 You get reminded your way

Evening before and morning of every hearing — Tarikh sends a WhatsApp reminder with the full case details. Monday mornings, a weekly summary goes out. Conflict alerts fire the moment two clashing dates are added. The lawyer sets their own reminder preferences. Tarikh runs quietly in the background.

08 — WITH TARIKH VS WITHOUT

The same day. Two completely different lawyers.

Without Tarikh	With Tarikh
Judge says next date. Lawyer writes it in the diary and hopes to read it correctly later.	✓ Lawyer sends one WhatsApp. Tarikh saves it, confirms it, and sets the reminder.
Night before a hearing — checking three different diaries and the phone calendar.	✓ Evening before — one WhatsApp from Tarikh. Case name, court number, time.
Two cases on the same day. Lawyer finds out when already at the wrong court.	✓ Tarikh flags the clash the moment the second case is added.
Client calls asking for the next date. Lawyer scrambles through the diary.	✓ Lawyer asks Tarikh. Gets the answer in 5 seconds.
Start of the week — no idea what's coming until opening the diary.	✓ Monday morning — Tarikh sends the full week's schedule before the first hearing.

09 — TECHNICAL APPROACH

How it's built.

Tarikh is architected for simplicity, reliability, and zero-friction user experience. The entire product is designed to work on a basic Android phone with a stable WhatsApp connection. No app download. No account creation. No onboarding flow.

Component	Technology	Purpose
WhatsApp Layer	Twilio WhatsApp Business API	Inbound/outbound message handling
AI Parsing Engine	Claude API (Anthropic)	Natural language understanding, Hinglish parsing, entity extraction
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Case storage, user preferences, reminder scheduling
Backend	Node.js / Python	Message routing, reminder scheduling, business logic
Hosting	Railway / Render	Cloud deployment, uptime monitoring
eCourts Integration	eCourts API (where available)	Date verification, CNR lookup (Phase 2)

Privacy & Data Security

Case details submitted by lawyers are stored securely and used only to deliver reminders and respond to queries. Tarikh does not share, sell, or analyse user data for any purpose other than delivering the product. Data is encrypted at rest and in transit. Each lawyer's data is isolated by their WhatsApp number.

10 — GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

How we reach lawyers.

Phase 1 — Personal Network Activation (Month 1–2)

Identify 20–30 solo advocates through personal connections, bar associations, and LinkedIn. Onboard each one personally via WhatsApp. Use these users to validate the core product loop and collect real usage data and testimonials.

Phase 2 — Social Proof & Content (Month 2–4)

Document the product journey publicly on LinkedIn — the problem, the insight, the build process, early user responses. Target Indian legal professionals, legal tech enthusiasts, and founders in the ecosystem. A well-told founder story at this stage builds inbound interest from both users and potential investors or collaborators.

Phase 3 — Bar Association Outreach (Month 3–6)

Partner with district bar associations to reach advocates at scale. Present Tarikh at bar association meetings and legal aid clinics. Advocate-to-advocate word of mouth is the highest trust channel in this community.

Pricing Strategy

Tier	Price	What's Included
Free	₹0 / month	Up to 5 active cases, basic reminders, schedule queries
Solo	₹199 / month	Unlimited cases, all features, CNR lookup, custom reminder times
Early Access	Free during beta	Full product access — building trust before monetising

11 — SUCCESS METRICS

How we measure progress.

Metric	Target — Month 1	Target — Month 3	Target — Month 6
Active users	10	100	500
Cases tracked	50	800	5,000
Reminders sent	100	2,000	15,000
7-day retention	60%	70%	75%
30-day retention	40%	55%	65%
WhatsApp messages/user/week	3	5	7
Paid conversion (post-beta)	—	—	15%

12 — ROADMAP

What we're building and when.

V1 — Core Product

Month 1–2

- WhatsApp-based case tracking via natural language
- Hearing reminders — evening before and morning of
- Case updates and adjournment handling
- On-demand schedule queries
- Monday weekly summary
- Conflict detection
- Case notes attached to reminders
- Custom reminder time preferences

V2 — Intelligence Layer

Month 3–5

- eCourts CNR integration — auto-fetch and verify dates
- Multi-language support — regional language inputs
- Case document storage — upload orders and judgments via WhatsApp
- Client reminder forwarding — send hearing reminders to clients
- Analytics — hearing history, adjournment patterns

V3 — Practice Layer

Month 6–12

- Multi-user — share cases with juniors or partners
- Fee tracking — log and track fees per case
- Client portal — simple web view for clients to see their case status
- Bar association integrations
- iOS and Android app (optional layer on top of WhatsApp core)

13 — WHY NOW

The moment is right.

WhatsApp is the default OS for India

With 500M+ Indian users, WhatsApp has achieved the kind of ubiquity that makes it the only distribution channel that requires zero adoption friction. Lawyers already use WhatsApp for client communication, document sharing, and coordination. A product that lives on WhatsApp skips the hardest part of any B2C product: getting someone to download and open a new app.

AI language understanding has reached the quality threshold

The ability to parse "sharma matter adj march 3 sessions" into a structured case record — accurately and reliably — was not possible at production scale two years ago. It is now. Claude and similar LLMs have made natural language understanding good enough that the product can work without training the user to change their behaviour.

Legal tech in India is at an inflection point

The eCourts initiative has digitised case data. The post-COVID shift to virtual hearings accelerated tech literacy among advocates. The infrastructure for legal tech to work is now in place. The gap is not awareness — it is a product built for the right user in the right channel.

The market is completely unaddressed

Every legal tech product in India targets law firms, corporate legal departments, or metro-based High Court advocates. The 1.5 million solo district court lawyers have been ignored entirely. This is not a crowded market. It is an empty one.

